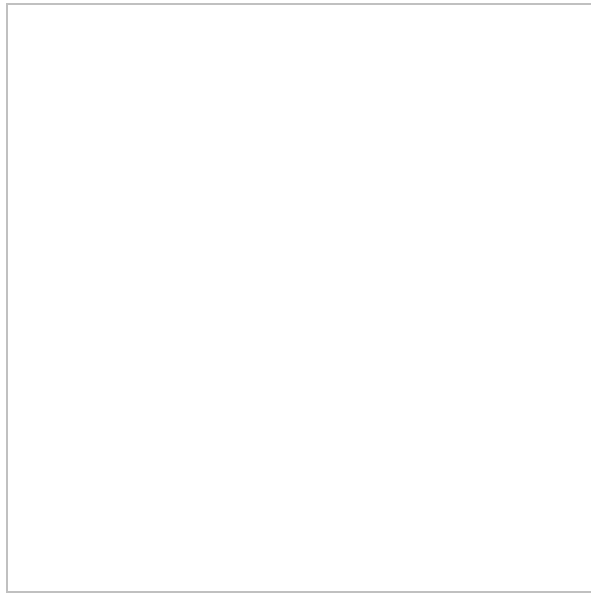




PROGRAM FOR *ALEKO*, 1893

A program for the premiere of Rachmaninoff's first opera, *Aleko*, on May 9, 1893, at the Bolshoi Theater in Moscow. The libretto, written by Vladimir Nemirovich-Danchenko, was an adaptation of Alexander Pushkin's poem *The Gypsies*.

## Brighter days

Rachmaninoff was badly shaken by the experience and composed almost nothing for the next three years, but he remained in demand as a pianist and also won plaudits as a conductor. He was helped out of his despondency by having hypnotherapy treatment with the music-loving Dr. Nikolai Dahl. His confidence restored, he began work on his Piano Concerto No. 2 (dedicated to Dr. Dahl), which he successfully premiered in 1901. With its achingly beautiful melodies and great waves of emotion leading